Rufus Goes AWOL!

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BDT 2021 · Celtic Manor · Featuring Rufus & Knoxy

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Due to the ongoing Covid restrictions, BDT 2021 to Celtic Manor was the second consecutive UK-based tour, with international travel curtailed. As a consequence, a number of the Dogs were straining at the leash by the time tour arrived, not least the Captains for that tour, Langers and Rufus!



BDT 2021 – The calm before the storm!

At the OC, Langers regaled us with a 45-minute tale of his impromptu meeting with Rufus in Shanghai in the middle of his running a redundancy consultation process, which was simply priceless! He then unveiled a SPICY bottle of Chinese liquor, aptly named “Ming River”, which inevitably led to a rapid deterioration in the sobriety of both captains when they started voluntarily necking shots of it. Unsurprisingly, as the noise levels rose we were turfed out of the OC meeting room by an impatient Celtic Manor staff member. In those times of Covid, the hotel bars had all closed but, fortunately, BT had secured himself an executive suite via some smelly patter and so we all trooped up there to continue proceedings.

Over the course of the remainder of the evening, we received several further warnings from the Celtic Manor staff about our volume levels, with the Captains by far the worst culprits. Eventually, after trashing BT’s room, we decided to call it a night before we were ejected from the hotel!

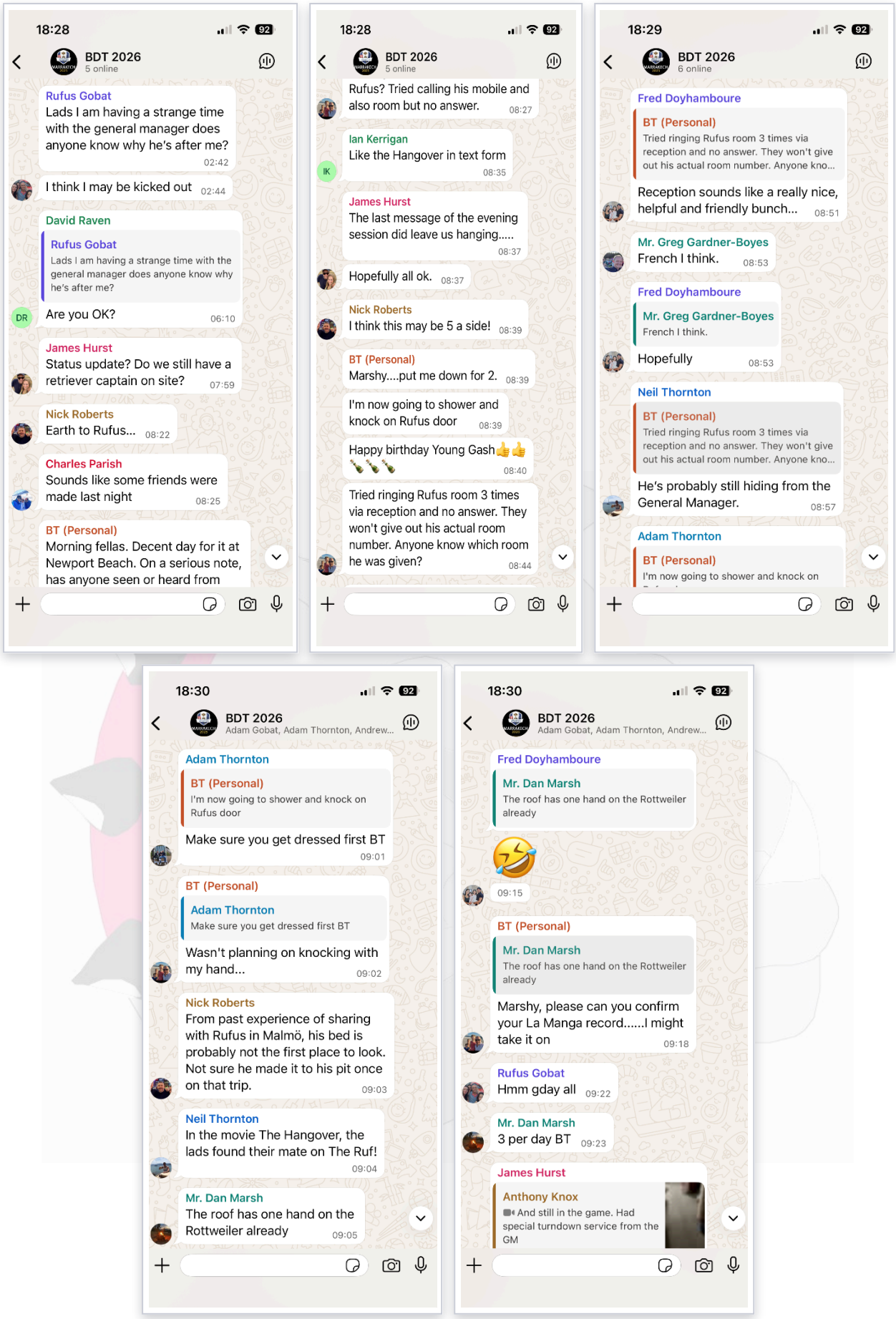


A quiet night in

Come the following morning the damage on the trolley outside BT’s suite showed why many, particularly the by-now spewing Langers, were feeling a little tender after the previous night’s antics.

More concerning, however, was the WhatsApp message received from Rufus at 2:42am…

A series of amusing messages followed, including several from non-tourists who were enjoying the tour from afar.



A selection of WhatsApps

To everyone's relief it transpired that the hotel manager had assisted Rufus to his hotel room and next door neighbour Knoxy had the foresight to video the key moment of locating our missing hound!



▶ **Watch:** The Ruf!



Champagne Breakfast for Young Ash's Birthday